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SELECTIVE
ATTENTION

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SELECTIVE ATTENTION

Focus on relevant information

Attention prioritizes selected information while filtering competing stimuli.

Cocktail-party effect shows selective filtering.

Mnemonic: Focus one, filter many.

Stimuli → Filter → Focus

↓

**ATTENTIONAL
GATE**

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**SCALAR
EXPECTANCY**

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**INATTENTIONAL
BLINDNESS**

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**NARRATIVE
TRANSPORTATION**

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**MERE
EXPOSURE**

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WORKING MEMORY

Temporary mental workspace

Working memory temporarily holds and manipulates information during ongoing cognition.

Capacity is limited and easily overloaded.

Mnemonic: Hold, manipulate, discard.

Input → [WORKSPACE] → Action

INATTENTIONAL BLINDNESS

Missing what you overlook

People can miss visible events when attention is occupied elsewhere.

Attention determines what reaches awareness.

Mnemonic: Not attended, often not noticed.

Attention → ●
Elsewhere → ?

SCALAR EXPECTANCY

How humans perceive time

Internal timing models explain how perceived duration scales with actual duration.

Timing variability scales with interval length.

Mnemonic: Longer time, wider uncertainty.

Short → ●●●
Long → ● ● ●

ATTENTIONAL GATE

Attention controls processing access

The attentional gate determines which sensory information receives deeper processing.

Limited attention creates a processing bottleneck.

Mnemonic: Gate open, information gets through.

Input → [GATE] → Processing
X

MERE EXPOSURE

Familiarity can increase liking

Repeated exposure to a stimulus can increase preference when initial reactions are neutral.

Repetition can build familiarity.

Mnemonic: Familiar feels favorable.

Exposure ↑ → Familiarity ↑
→ Liking ↑

NARRATIVE TRANSPORT

Stories absorb mental attention

People become mentally immersed in stories, reducing attention to the surrounding environment.

Immersion increases emotional involvement.

Mnemonic: Story → Transport → Emotion.

Story → Immersion → Emotion

TESTING EFFECT

Retrieval strengthens memory

Actively retrieving information improves later memory more than repeated passive studying.

Recall beats repeated rereading.

Mnemonic: Retrieve to reinforce.

Learn → Retrieve → Remember
↑

SPACING EFFECT

Distributed learning lasts longer

Spreading study sessions improves long-term retention compared with cramming.

Spacing strengthens later retrieval.

Mnemonic: Space it, save it.

Study → Gap → Study
↓
Recall